

Gabriela Penarska

Product Designer

gabriela.penarska@gmail.com · gabrielpenarska.framer.website · linkedin.com/in/gabriela-penarska

Dear Asana Design Team,

I make complex systems simple to work in, and I am always curious about how new AI tools can help teams move faster and decide better. My career has been about taking dense, tangled information and turning it into something people can move through with confidence, which is what the Coordinate team is doing as it evolves Asana into an operating system for human and AI teams.

At Nacos Marine, I led end-to-end interaction and interface design for vessel-monitoring products across web, desktop, and onboard HMI, shipping to 13,000+ vessels and 30,000+ daily users. My process is human-centered and evidence-led. I draw out the non-obvious needs through co-creation workshops and user research, synthesise what I find into a narrow, well-defined problem, and communicate a clear design rationale grounded in research, so a cross-functional team of product managers, engineers, and developers across several countries can align. Earlier, at Cytiva, I contributed to a design system and internal tools, including an hour-tracking redesign that cut daily task time for 500+ employees. Consistent, well-crafted systems are how I keep quality high as work scales.

What excites me most is a question where should a system act on its own, and where does the person stay in control? I co-designed an AI storytelling system for children, letting the child set the direction at each turn while the model generates within guardrails. During my master's in Human-Centered AI, I researched and designed a mobile reading app for low-vision users, working through rough concepts to a tested design to understand how a system should step in without breaking a user's focus. I was designing the balance of agency between reader and system, essentially choosing where on the human-in-the-loop spectrum the experience should sit and testing what preserved the reader's sense of control. Besides that, I design with AI tools like Figma Make and Claude Design daily to speed up my workflow, so I can prototype and test an idea quickly.

I have always chased new contexts to learn from, from exchange studies in Tokyo and Lisbon to picking up filmmaking, where I shoot, colour, and edit short documentaries from my travels. I would be glad to bring this curiosity and craft to the Coordinate team.

Warmly,

Gabriela Penarska